

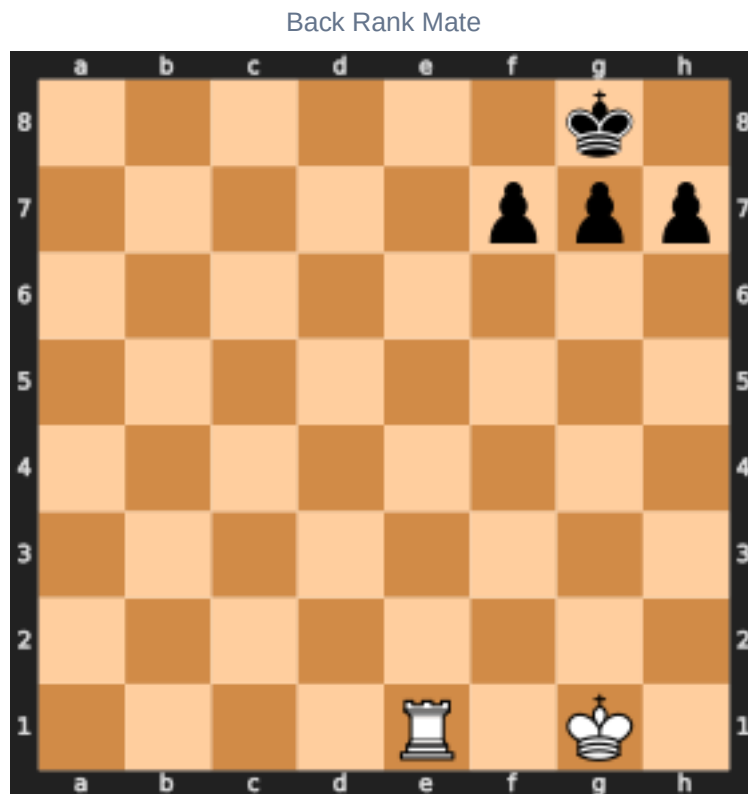
CHEAT SHEET

Common Checkmate Patterns

Visual guide to 25 essential checkmate patterns every player should recognize

1. Back Rank Mate

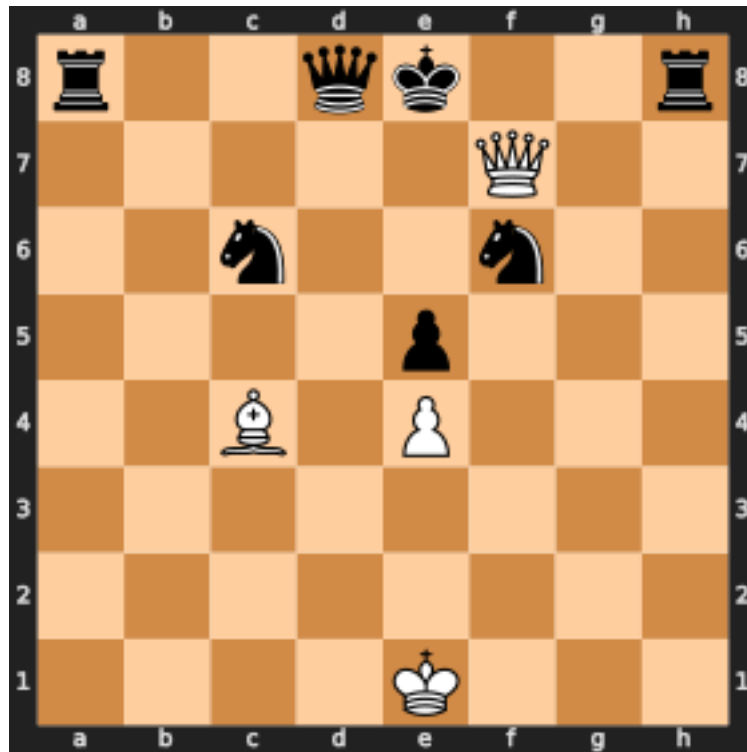
A Rook or Queen delivers checkmate on the 1st or 8th rank when the King is trapped behind its own pawns.



2. Scholar's Mate

Queen and Bishop combine to attack f7 (or f2). A common beginner trap: 1.e4 e5 2.Bc4 Nc6 3.Qh5 Nf6?? 4.Qxf7#.

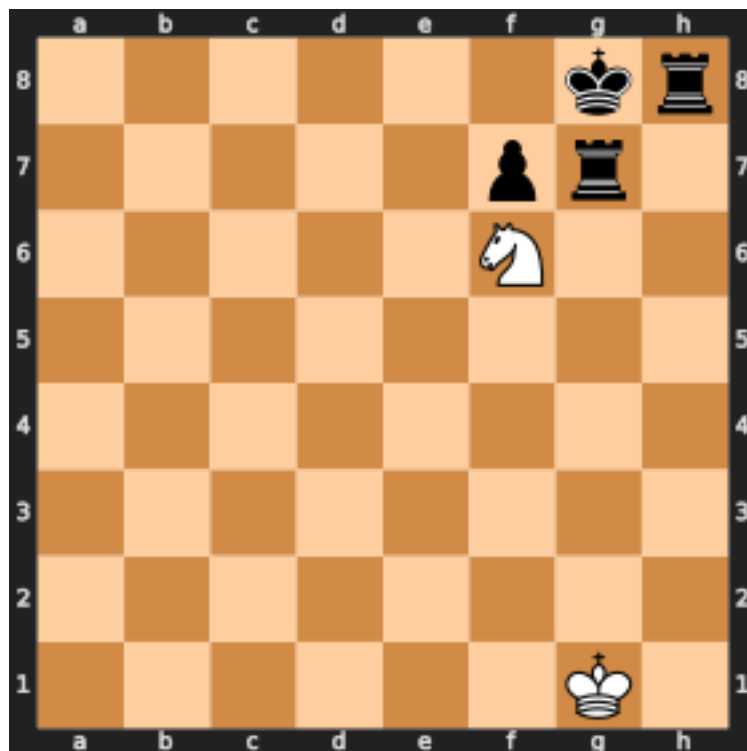
Scholar's Mate



3. Smothered Mate

A Knight delivers checkmate when the King is completely surrounded by its own pieces.

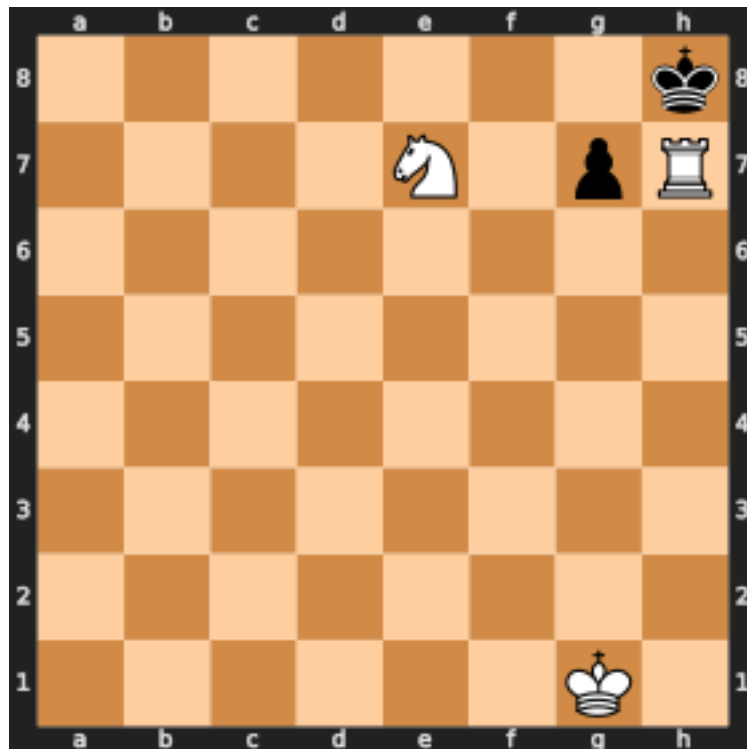
Smothered Mate



4. Anastasia's Mate

A Rook and Knight combine on the edge of the board, with the Knight controlling escape squares.

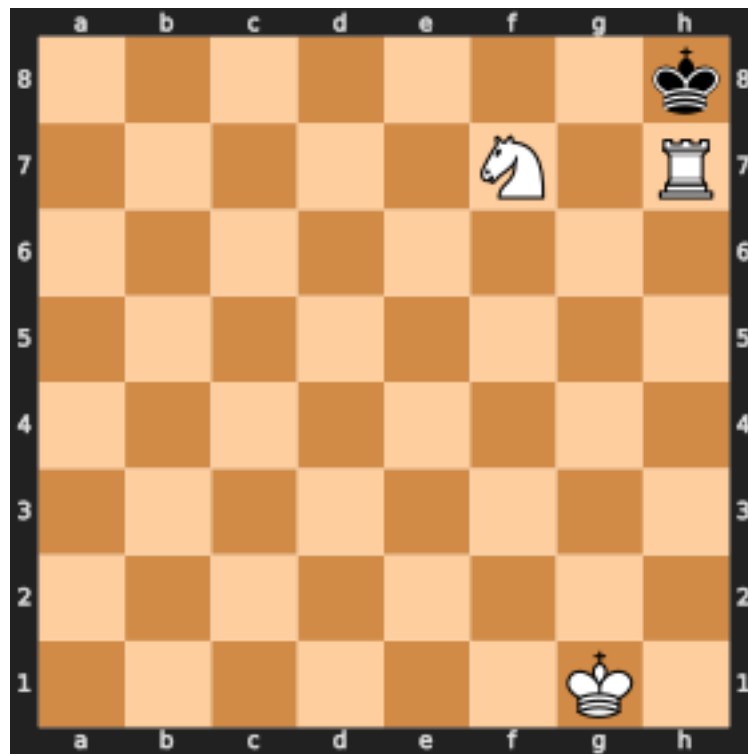
Anastasia's Mate



5. Arabian Mate

A Rook and Knight team up. The Knight covers the King's escape squares while the Rook delivers check.

Arabian Mate



More Essential Patterns

6. Hook Mate — Rook, Knight, and Pawn create a mating net
7. Greco's Mate — Bishop and Rook coordinate on the diagonal and file
8. Boden's Mate — Two Bishops on crossing diagonals
9. Epaullette Mate — Queen checkmates when King is flanked by its own Rooks
10. Double Bishop Mate — Two Bishops deliver mate on adjacent diagonals
11. Damiano's Mate — Queen sacrifices on h7 followed by Rook lift
12. Lolli's Mate — Queen on g7 supported by a pawn
13. Kill Box / Box Mate — King + Queen vs King in the corner
14. Ladder Mate — Two Rooks alternate checks, pushing King to the edge
15. Blackburne's Mate — Two Bishops and a Knight coordinate
16. Pillsbury's Mate — Rook supported by Bishop delivers back rank mate
17. Réti's Mate — Bishop defends from distance while piece gives check
18. Max Lange's Mate — Queen and Bishop on adjacent diagonals
19. Opera Mate — Rook delivers mate on back rank, supported by Bishop
20. Morphy's Mate — Bishop and Rook mate on the edge
21. Dovetail Mate — Queen mates with King's escape blocked by own pieces
22. Swallow's Tail Mate — Queen mates, King trapped by own Rooks
23. Suffocation Mate — Knight mates on enclosed position
24. Corner Mate — Knight checks in corner with Bishop support
25. Corridor Mate — Rook mates along a rank/file in a narrow corridor

Ø=Ü; TIP: Study these patterns until you recognize them instantly. In your games, always ask: "Is there a checkmate pattern here?" The more patterns you know, the more you'll find!